07-19 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Middle-School Students Be Allowed to Keep Pets at Home?

① Walk into any classroom on a Monday morning, and you will hear the same happy noise: "My dog learned a new trick!" "My cat slept on my head!" For many of us, pets are not just animals — they are family. Yet in many homes, a serious discussion is going on: *Should a middle-school student really be allowed to keep a pet?* Some parents worry about time, money, or allergies. In my view, **with clear rules and shared responsibility, keeping a pet is good for middle-school students, and parents should say yes more often**.

② The first reason is **responsibility**. A pet needs food, water, walks, and a clean sleeping place every single day — not only when the weather is fine or when we feel like it. A cat does not care that we have a math test tomorrow. A dog does not care that our favourite show is starting. Caring for a small, living creature teaches us, in the most direct way, that other lives depend on our actions. This lesson is hard to find in any textbook. Students who keep pets often become better at managing small daily tasks: setting an alarm to feed the fish, remembering to close a door so the cat does not run away, planning pocket money to buy rabbit food. These are life skills that grow slowly, day by day.

③ The second reason is **mental health**. The middle-school years are full of pressure: exams, homework, and sometimes trouble with friends. Research from 2026 showed that teenagers with a pet at home reported **20% less** feeling of loneliness than those without. A pet does not judge us. After a bad score, a dog still wags its tail. After a quiet afternoon, a cat still lies on the maths book. This simple, calm love helps students feel safe when the school day has been difficult. Taking a dog for a short evening walk also brings us outdoors, away from screens, and helps us sleep better.

④ Of course, not everyone agrees. Some parents say, "Middle-school students are too busy; they cannot take care of a pet." This is a fair worry. But the answer is not to refuse completely; the answer is to **share the work**. The student can feed and walk the pet on weekdays; parents can help at weekends. Before getting a pet, the family should sit down and make a simple written plan — who does what, on which days, and what happens if the student is sick. When responsibility is shared and clear, pets do not take away from study time; they help us use small bits of time (a ten-minute walk, a five-minute feeding) more consciously.

⑤ Another worry is **cost and space**. This is real, and it matters. A big dog in a small flat is not kind to the dog or to the family. But "pet" does not only mean a large dog. A pair of goldfish, a quiet hamster, or a friendly rabbit can live well in a small space and cost very little. The key is to match the pet to the family, not to follow the trend of the classroom.

⑥ A final concern is **allergies and safety**. Some students sneeze the moment a cat enters the room. Before bringing any pet home, the family should visit a friend's home with the same kind of pet for an afternoon, or ask the doctor for a simple test. Safety and health must always come first. A careful choice is a kind choice, both to the child and to the animal.

⑦ Pets are not toys. They are small lives that need years of care. But for a middle-school student who is ready, a pet can be a teacher of patience, a medicine for loneliness, and a warm friend during the hardest years of growing up. The question for parents is not "Is my child old enough?" — it is "How can we help our child be ready?" When families take the question seriously, the answer to the first question will often be yes.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What is the writer's main opinion?

A. Middle-school students should never keep pets.
B. Only rich families should keep pets.
C. With clear rules and shared work, middle-school students should be allowed to keep pets, and parents should agree more often.
D. Schools, not homes, should keep all the pets.

2. According to the passage, how does having a pet help students with responsibility?

A. Pets teach students new subjects for the exam.
B. Pets do the students' homework for them.
C. Pets give small daily tasks (feeding, walking, cleaning) that teach students that other lives depend on their actions.
D. Pets buy food for themselves.

3. What does the 2026 study mentioned in paragraph ③ tell us?

A. Teenagers with pets reported 20% less loneliness than those without pets.
B. All teenagers without pets are unhappy.
C. Pets make teenagers sleep worse.
D. Pets can do the students' maths homework.

4. How does the writer answer the worry that "students are too busy to care for a pet"?

A. Students should give up all hobbies to care for the pet.
B. Families should share the work and make a clear written plan.
C. Students should never study on the days they have a pet.
D. Only weekends are safe for keeping a pet.

5. What is the writer's suggestion about allergies and safety?

A. Ignore them; they will disappear.
B. Before getting a pet, visit a friend's home with the same pet or ask a doctor.
C. Never keep any pet, just to be safe.
D. Let the child sneeze for a week to test.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】首段尾句 "with clear rules and shared responsibility..."
【解析】有规则、共分担的前提下应支持养宠。A/B/D 均偏。故选 C。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "A pet needs food, water, walks... other lives depend on our actions."
【解析】每日照料教会学生责任。A/B/D 荒谬。故选 C。

3.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "reported 20% less feeling of loneliness..."
【解析】养宠青少年孤独感少 20%。B 以偏概全；C/D 与原文反或荒谬。故选 A。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第④段 "share the work... make a simple written plan..."
【解析】家庭共同分担并制定书面计划。A/C/D 与原文不符。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段 "visit a friend's home... or ask the doctor..."
【解析】提前测试或问医生。A/C/D 均不合理。故选 B。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **responsibility** [n.] 责任
- **allergy** [n.] 过敏
- **loneliness** [n.] 孤独
- **consciously** [adv.] 自觉地
- **hamster** [n.] 仓鼠